

THOMASVONMOSSNERGETYOURGUIDEEDIT

Travel Radio Australia, and we are at the Arrival 360 event in Brisbane. I have Thomas von Mosner from Get Your Guide, based in Bangkok. Thomas, welcome to the program.

Thanks. Thanks for having me. So yeah, von Mosner, if it would be Dutch, would be fan.

Born and raised in Munich, but now since 16 and a half years in Asia, mostly in Bangkok. Joined the whole startup world back then. Built 10 years a food delivery company called Foodpanda, but now joins the beautiful world of the OTAs only recently last year in November.

And yeah, ever since I'm the sales director for APAC for Get Your Guide. Get Your Guide being the biggest European marketplace for experiences on OTA for experiences. Shows and events as well.

Now about 15, 16 years old. So it's a founding story out of Zurich and Berlin. Currently headquartered in Berlin and yeah, globally operating.

Out of Bangkok, we manage the whole of APAC. So that includes an office in Hong Kong, office in Tokyo, office in Sydney. And that's also why we are sitting now in Brisbane and meeting on arrivals.

Yeah, I mean, I personally enjoy this industry a lot. I mean, it's a beautiful product. It's still a very early stage of how the industry developed, right? There was a whole era of flight tickets, hotel tickets.

I think now it's time for the experience industry to scale up. And I mean, for me, Asia and Asia-Pacific remains the most important and most fascinating region on this planet. Just looking at demographics, looking at opportunities and looking how early stage the market still is.

Personally, I traveled a lot 16 years in the region to a degree where I got a little bit sick of beaches. And the most recent travels I did was rather towards the mountains. So what I can really recommend is in the north of Vietnam, there are a few motorbike tours that you can do.

I'm a passionate driver myself in Thailand. There's a famous loop called Ha Giang Loop, which is in the north, but basically the border region to China, where you can do different versions of the trip. But I did a five-day loop across the mountain ranges.

And it looks like New Zealand, funny enough. I personally even didn't know that Vietnam has mountains like this. And in the wintertime, they're even snow-capped.

So I can really recommend discovering Southeast Asia more, discovering Vietnam. Second trip I did that really impressed me recently, and that's back to the islands and to the beach life, is in Indonesia to the Manta Ways. It's an island group quite in the middle of nowhere.

So you need to fly to a city called Padang and then take a speedboat for three hours into the open ocean. And then you hit an island group, Archipelago, that is world-famous for surfing. Zero infrastructure, no electricity.

Everything is just generators and skies and stars. The best waves in the world, where people from all over the world actually are traveling to. And yeah, you can see I'm very passionate.

I use my own product a lot and I'm happy to meet you here. Now, Get Your Guide, how did that kick off? Was it your idea, someone else's idea, you collaborated with somebody? No, not my idea. I mean, we have four founders who are still actually with the company.

Two of them are in the CEO and COO position. And the founding story goes like this, that they were university friends studying in Zurich. One of the founders is actually born in Beijing and they planned a Beijing trip.

However, the other founder, the German part, made a booking mistake and arrived one day too early in Beijing. And that's, again, 16 years ago. So pre-smartphone, pre-OTAs.

And had to kind of bridge 24 hours until the other, his friend, arrived. And he was completely helpless, he said. Like he had zero translation.

He didn't know where to go. He wanted to go to the Great Wall and kind of failed, right? Until a day later, his friend arrived who speaks, obviously, the languages from there. That was the first guided tour in that sense for him personally.

And suddenly the whole, you know, the whole magic of China, the whole magic of Beijing unfolded. And that was then somewhat the idea where they said, okay, it's actually like a guided tour will bring you an experience that will never forget and has such a magic to it. That when they flew back to Zurich to continue their studies, they actually started Get Your Guide or the first version of it.

And ever since they're building, pivoting, iterating, and yeah, made it now to, well, one of the biggest booking platforms there is for experiences. Around 100 million monthly visitors right to the site, 1 million download, more than 300 million bookings per year. So significant in size and still early stage because as I said, right, I think this industry is just about to be unfolded.

Well, it's an incredible story from virtually nothing, just university friends, 16 years ago to where Get Your Guide is today. And it's tremendous to meet you here and be a part of this. And what is Get Your Guide's future plans? What is the expansion plans? Yeah.

So as I said, it's around 15 years old. The majority of the 15 years we were focusing on Europe, unlocking Europe, winning Europe as a source market and destination market. Then there was a brief period where we invested a lot into the USA, Northern America, opened up a big office in

New York.

But now is really the time for APAC, right? So we focus investments here. We are doubling our teams. We're really going into expansion mode.

And I'm very optimistic that in the next five years with all those investments, with specific focus, with dedication into product and understanding the local nuances better, this will be the next big growth opportunity for Get Your Guide. And I'm very lucky to be spearheading this for the company and can't wait to see what's happening next. Well, it's been tremendous talking to you, Thomas von Mosner from Get Your Guide.

It's tremendous to have you on the program on Travel Radio Australia. And how can people find out more online? Please find us under getyourguide.com or just download our app, which is available for all systems, iOS or Android. And yeah, follow us on social media.

There's a lot of things coming your way. And next time you travel and you want to experience something magical, come to Get Your Guide. Thanks, Thomas.